61 Numbers

A Cardinal numbers

379 = three **hundred** and seventy-nine
5,084 = five thousand and eighty-four
2,000,000 = two **million**
2,860 = two **thousand**, eight hundred and sixty
470,000 = four hundred and seventy thousand
3,000,000,000 = three **billion**

Language help

There is no plural 's' after *hundred, thousand, million* and *billion* when they are part of a number. When we are talking generally, they are plural, e.g. ***thousands*** *of people,* ***millions*** *of insects*.

B Dates

With dates, we write them and say them in a different way.
We can write **4 June** or **June 4th**, but say **the fourth of June** or **June the fourth**.
We can write **21 May** or **May 21st**, but say the **twenty-first of May** or **May the twenty-first**.
1997 = **nineteen ninety-seven**; 2016 = **two thousand and sixteen** or **twenty sixteen**

Common mistakes

The **seventh** of April (NOT The ~~seven~~ April); the **fourth** question (NOT the ~~four~~ question)

C Fractions and decimals

1¼ = one and **a quarter**
1½ = one and **a half**
1¾ = one and **three quarters**
1.25 = one **point** two five
1.5 = one point five
1.75 = one point seven five

D Percentages

26% is spoken as twenty-six **per cent**. More than 50% of something is the **majority of** it, less than 50% of something is the **minority**:
The **vast majority** of the students (e.g. 95%) agreed with the new plan, only a **small minority** (e.g. 5%) were unhappy.

E Calculations

There are four basic processes. Notice how they are said when we are **working out** [trying to **calculate**] the answer.

+ = **addition** e.g. 6 + 4 = 10 (six **plus**/**and** four **equals**/**is** ten)
– = **subtraction** e.g. 6 – 4 = 2 (six **minus** four is two)
x = **multiplication** e.g. 6 x 4 = 24 (six **multiplied by** / **times** four is twenty-four)
÷ = **division** e.g. 8 ÷ 2 = 4 (eight **divided by** two is four)

Some people are not very good at **adding up** numbers [putting numbers together to reach a total], and often **get stuck** [have a problem] if they have to work out something quite difficult. The easiest way is to use a **calculator** [a small electronic machine for working out numbers].

F Saying '0'

'0' can be spoken in different ways in different situations:
telephone number: 603449 = six **oh** three, **double** four nine OR six **zero** three, **double** four nine
mathematics: 0.7 = **nought** point seven; 6.02 = six point **oh** two OR six point **nought** two
temperature: –10 degrees = ten degrees below **zero** OR **minus** ten degrees

Exercises

61.1 **How do you say these numbers in English? Write the answers in words, then practise saying them.**

1 462 *four hundred and sixty-two*
2 2½ .....
3 2,345 .....
4 0.25 .....
5 1,250,000 .....
6 10.04 .....
7 47% .....
8 10 September .....
9 940338 (phone number) .....
10 -5 Celsius .....
11 in 1996 .....
12 2012 .....

61.2 **Correct the mistakes.**

1 Two thousand and five hundred. *Two thousand, five hundred*
2 After the game, I heard that the crowd was over twenty thousands. .....
3 We arrived on the seven June. .....
4 There were two hundred twenty altogether. .....
5 My birthday is the thirty-one August. .....
6 My phone number is seven twenty-three, six nought nine. .....

61.3 **Complete the sentences.**

1 Eight *multiplied* by seven is fifty-six.
2 The ..... were in favour of the new airport; about 80%, I think.
3 A small ..... did not support the idea, but it was only 5%.
4 I'm not very good at arithmetic. I always have to use a ..... .
5 When I tried to add ..... all the numbers, I couldn't ..... it out.
6 I can do simple calculations, but I get ..... if the numbers are very big.

61.4 **Can you work out the answers? If you find it difficult, use paper or a calculator.**

1 23 and 36 is *fifty-nine* .
2 24 times 3 is ..... .
3 80 minus 20 is ..... .
4 65 divided by 13 is ..... .
5 Add 10 and 6, multiply by 3, then subtract 15 and divide by 11. What number is left?
.....
6 Divide 33 by 11, multiply by 7, add 10, and subtract 16. What number is left? .....

61.5 Over to you

Answer the questions. Write your answers in words.

1 When were you born? .....
2 How tall are you? .....
3 What's the number of the flat or house where you live? .....
4 When's your birthday? .....
5 What's the approximate population of your town? .....
6 What's your body temperature? .....

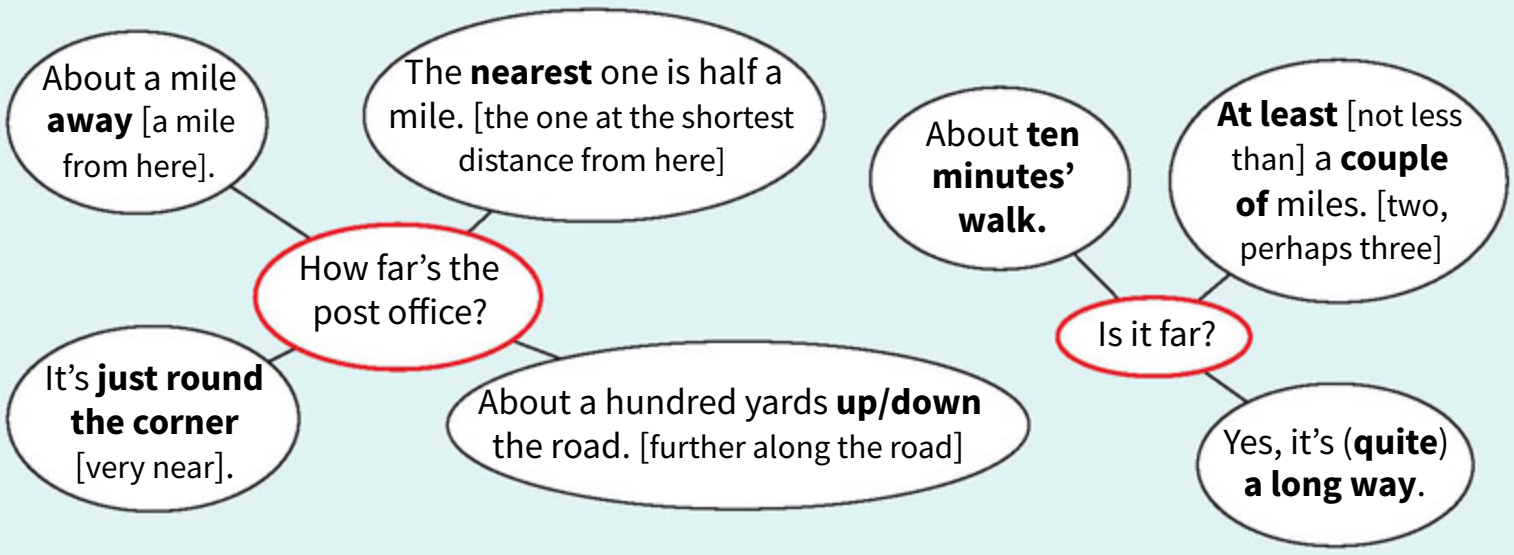
62 Distance, dimensions and size

A Distance: how far …

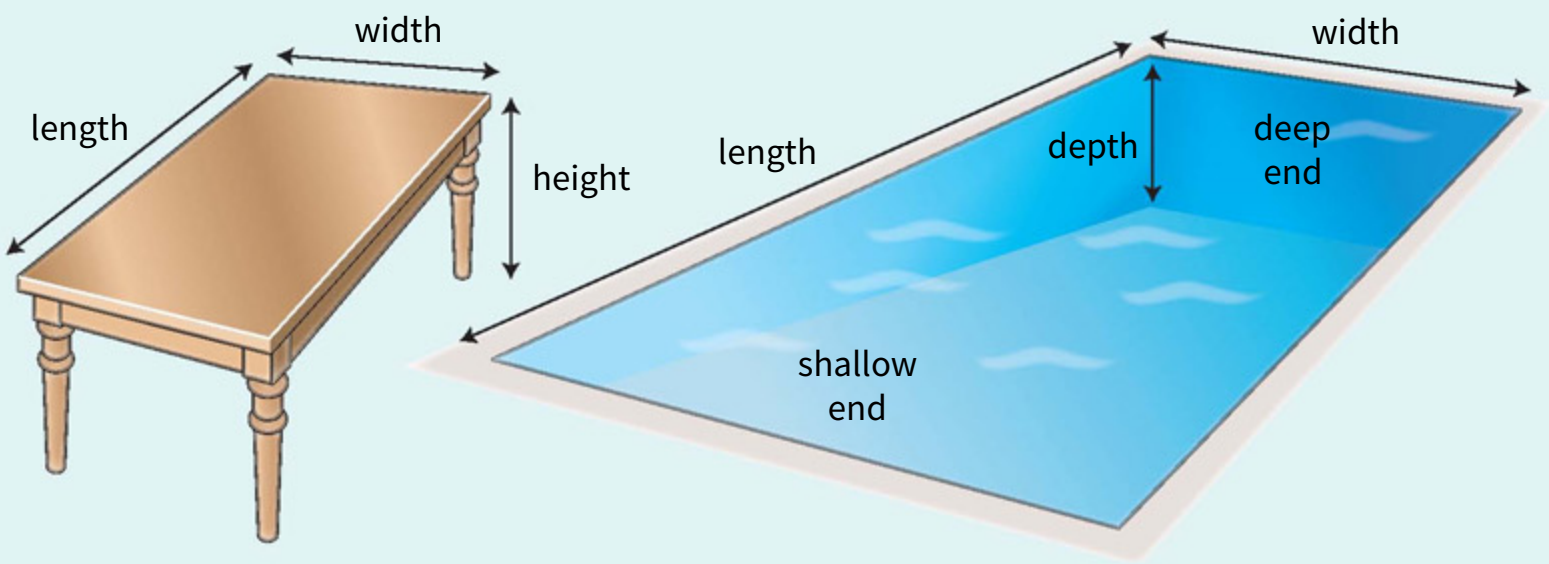
British people buy most things in metres, centimetres and millimetres, but they still often talk about distance using the old system of **miles** [1 mile = about 1.6 kilometres], **yards** [1 yard = almost 1 metre], **feet** [1 foot = 30 centimetres], and **inches** [1 inch = 2.5 centimetres].

Common mistakes

It's ten minutes' walk from here. (NOT ten minutes' ~~walking~~.)
It's a long way. (NOT It's ~~far~~.) But we can say 'No, it isn't far.'



B Dimensions: how long or wide …



Common mistakes

Mason is quite **tall** (NOT quite ~~high~~). It's a **tall** tree/building (NOT a ~~high~~ tree/building). It's a **high** mountain (NOT a ~~tall~~ mountain).

We can ask about the dimensions like this:

What's the **length** of the garage? OR How **long** is the garage?	It's five metres (**long**).
What's the **width** of the path? OR How **wide** is the path?	It's a metre (**wide**).
What's the **height** of the wall? OR How **high** is the wall?	It's two metres (**high**).
What's the **depth** of the pool? OR How **deep** is the pool?	It's three metres (**deep**).

C Size: how big or small …

We use a range of adjectives to describe the size of something.

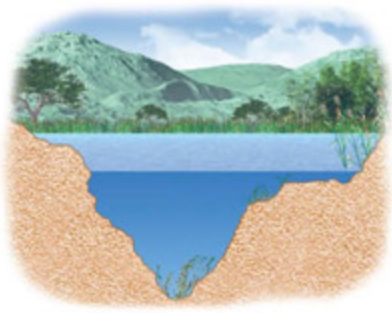
It was a very **thick** book – over 500 pages. (*opp* a **thin** book)
Their living room is **huge** [very big; *syn* **enormous**; *opp* a **tiny** room].
We caught a **giant** crab. [very large or bigger than other similar things]
It was a very **narrow** road for a bus. (*opp* a **wide** road)

Exercises

62.1 **Disagree with the speaker in each dialogue.**

1 A: It's only a thin book, isn't it?
B: No, *it's quite thick.*
2 A: The water's deep in the middle, isn't it?
B: No, ...
3 A: Is the road very wide at that point?
B: No, ...
4 A: James is quite short, isn't he?
B: No, ...
5 A: They only live in a small place, don't they?
B: No, ...
6 A: Is it a really huge pool?
B: No, ...

62.2 **Complete the questions (in two ways) about the lake, the mountain, the woman and the football pitch.**









1 How *deep* ..... is the lake?
2 What's ..... the lake?
3 How ..... is the mountain?
4 What's ..... the mountain?
5 How ..... is she?
6 What's her ..... ?
7 How ..... is the pitch?
8 What's ..... the pitch?

62.3 Over to you

Think about the building you are in now, and answer the questions using expressions from the opposite page.

1 How far is it to the nearest shop? .....
2 How far is it to a bank? .....
3 Is it very far to the nearest bus stop? .....
4 Is it very far to a post office? .....
5 Is it a long way to the nearest swimming pool? .....
6 Is it a long way to the next big town? .....
7 How far is the nearest train station? .....
8 Is it far to the centre of town? .....

63 Objects, materials, shapes and colour

A Objects[1] and materials[2]

[1] things you can see or touch [2] what something is made of or from



object	material	description
1 a **bell**	**metal**	used in hotel receptions
2 a chair	wood	an **antique** [an object that is old and often rare or beautiful]
3 a hat	**fur**	made from a **real** animal
4 a **bone**	**rubber**	a **toy** for dogs
5 a **flag**	cloth, e.g. cotton	the Italian **national** flag
6 a shirt	**cotton**	it has red **stripes**
7 a top	**silk**	beautifully soft and stylish
8 a sofa	**leather**	**stylish** [fashionable and attractive]
9 a **ladder**	metal	light and easy to carry
10 a **tissue**	paper	a soft piece of paper that you use for cleaning your nose
11 a **bucket**	**plastic**	used to clean floors

Language help

Most of the materials above can be adjectives or nouns, e.g. *a cotton shirt*, or *a shirt made of cotton; a leather sofa*, or *a sofa made of leather*. The exception is wood: a chair made of wood is *a **wooden** chair*.

B Shapes and colours


a **grey square**


a **pink star**


a **navy blue circle**


a **green semi-circle**


a **purple heart**


a **round** ball


a **square** box


shoes with **pointed** toes

Language help

When we want to say that a shape is 'almost round' or a colour is 'a sort of green', we can also express this idea with the suffix **-ish**, e.g. *She had a **roundish** face; He wore a **greenish** tie*.

Exercises

63.1 **Put the words into the correct columns.**

~~bell~~	circle	pink	silk	flag	grey	cotton	purple
plastic	bucket	fur	ladder	square	navy blue		

objects	materials	shapes	colours
bell			

63.2 **Match the words on the left with the words on the right.**

1 a plastic	[d]	a	scarf
2 a silk	[ ]	b	hat
3 a rubber	[ ]	c	belt
4 a fur	[ ]	d	toy
5 a cotton	[ ]	e	tyre (on the wheel of a car)
6 a leather	[ ]	f	T-shirt

63.3 **Label the objects, and their shape or colour.**



1 *a grey sofa* .....



3 .....



5 .....



2 .....



4 .....



6 .....

63.4 **Which object is being described?**

1 It's got a point at one end and that's the end you write with. *a pencil*
2 It's a shellfish. It is usually grey, but it goes pink when you cook it. .....
3 It can be metal or plastic and you often put water in it to wash floors. .....
4 It is usually made of wood or metal, and you climb up it. .....
5 At certain times of the month it's round; at others, it's closer to a semi-circle. .....
6 An adult human body has 206 of these. .....

63.5 Over to you

Answer the questions. If possible, compare your answers with someone else.

1 Do you wear shoes with pointed toes?

2 What clothes do you have that are pink, purple or navy blue?

3 Do you wear anything that has stripes? If so, what?

4 Do you have any clothes that are made from silk or fur?

5 What things do you own that are made of leather?

64 Containers and quantities

A Containers and contents*



a **bag of** shopping



a **bottle of** apple juice



a **jar of** jam



a **bowl of** sugar



a **jug of** water



a **box of** chocolates



a **packet of** biscuits



a **packet of** crisps



a **can of** cola



a **carton of** orange juice



a **tube of** toothpaste



a **vase of** flowers



a **tin of** fruit



a **bar of** chocolate

* the things inside something

Language help

A **tin** usually has something we eat inside it; a **can** has something we drink.

B Quantities*

Just a **drop of** milk [a very small amount] and no sugar in my coffee, please.
I've cut three **slices of** beef; that should be enough for the sandwiches. (Or three **pieces of** beef)
I took my boss a **bunch of** flowers when I visited her in hospital.
I need a **sheet of** paper. (Or a **piece**/**bit of** paper)
Andrew bought two **pairs of** trousers and a pair of shoes yesterday.
I bought **a couple of** books. [two, perhaps three]
We saw **several** churches on our way here. [some but not a lot, e.g. between three and eight]
I bought **half a dozen** eggs at the supermarket. [six]
There are a **dozen** students in the class. [twelve]
Could I have **a spoonful of** sugar in my tea?
We've got **plenty of** time. [a lot of]
The company is now making the toys **in large quantities**.

* the amount or number of something

three **slices of** beef





two **sheets of** paper



a spoonful of sugar



a bunch of keys

Language help

We can usually use **slice** when talking about pieces of bread, cakes and meat. We can use **bunch** to talk about flowers, grapes, bananas and keys.

Exercises

64.1 How do you pronounce the underlined letters? Use the index to help you.

1 t<u>i</u>n Is it like f<u>i</u>ne or w<u>i</u>nd? *wind*
2 p<u>ai</u>r Is it like c<u>ar</u> or c<u>are</u>?
3 v<u>a</u>se Is it like f<u>ar</u> or f<u>a</u>ce?
4 t<u>u</u>be Is it like n<u>oo</u>n or n<u>ew</u>?
5 c<u>ou</u>ple Is it like p<u>oo</u>l or c<u>u</u>p?
6 d<u>o</u>zen Is it like r<u>u</u>n or r<u>o</u>b?
7 qu<u>a</u>ntity Is it like r<u>a</u>n or w<u>a</u>nt?

64.2 Complete the phrases below.


1


3



5


7


9


2


4


6


8

1 a *bottle* of water
2 a ..... of spaghetti
3 a ..... of fruit
4 a ..... of coffee
5 a ..... of milk
6 a ..... of water
7 a ..... of matches
8 a ..... of soap
9 a ..... of apples

64.3 Correct the mistake with the container.

1 a ~~packet~~ of chocolate *bar*
2 a vase of jam .....
3 a tube of cigarettes .....
4 a tin of cola .....
5 a can of milk .....
6 a carton of toothpaste .....
7 a jar of flowers .....
8 a jug of biscuits .....

64.4 Complete the sentences with one word.

1 I need two *pairs* of socks inside these shoes.
2 I gave her a big ..... of flowers from my garden.
3 I cut about six ..... of bread and put them on a plate.
4 Could you get half a ..... more chairs?
5 The teacher told us to take out a blank ..... of paper.
6 I like to put a ..... of cream in my coffee.
7 There's no need to hurry – we've got ..... of time.
8 I met a ..... of friends – Stefan and Julia – on the way to the station.
9 She opened her bag on the table, turned it upside down, and all the ..... fell out.
10 Tennis is quite popular in our office. I know ..... people who play.

64.5 Cross out the wrong answer.

1 Could you get a carton of *milk / juice / ~~coffee~~?*
2 I bought a bunch of *grapes / bananas / apples*.
3 There were *a couple of / a pair of / several* people waiting at the bus stop.
4 Would you like a slice of *cake / bread / biscuit?*
5 It's nice with a spoonful of *sugar / jam / crisps*.
6 I bought two pairs of *socks / shirts / jeans*.
7 Have you got a *piece / bunch / sheet* of paper I could borrow?

65 Apologies, excuses and thanks

A Apologies with common replies

We can **apologise** [say sorry] in different ways in different situations.


A: **I'm(terribly/really) sorry** – I've forgotten your book.


B: **Never mind**. That's OK.

Terribly/really makes you sound 'more sorry'.


A: **I beg your pardon** – I didn't see you there.


B: **That's all right**. (also **That's OK**.)

I beg your pardon is a more formal apology, often used if you walk into someone.


A: (**I'm**) **sorry to disturb you**.


B: **Don't worry**. Come on in. I can finish this later.

We use this phrase when we **interrupt** / speak to someone who is busy working.


A: (**I'm**) **sorry to keep you waiting – I won't be long**.


B: OK. Fine.

We use this phrase when someone is waiting for us. *I won't be long* = I will be with you very soon.


A: **Excuse me,** I won't be a minute.


B: OK. Fine.

We use this phrase when we have to leave a room or go somewhere.


A: **I must apologise for** the noise last night.


B: That's all right. I understand.

This is a more formal apology, and it is often used in business letters.


A: **I'm(really) sorry I'm late**.


B: Don't worry.

Common mistakes

I'm sorry I'm late. (NOT I'm sorry ~~for be~~ late. OR I'm sorry ~~to be~~ late.)

B Excuses

We often give an explanation or **excuse** after an apology. An **excuse** is a *reason* for the apology, which may or may not be true. These are excuses students might give for being late for class.

I'm sorry I'm late for class …

– There was a **delay** / **hold-up** on the underground. [when a train, plane, etc. leaves or arrives later than you expect]
– I was **held up** in traffic. [**hold up** – cause a delay and make someone late – is often used in the passive]
– My train **was cancelled** [the train company decided not to run the train], and I had to wait half an hour for the next one.
– I **overslept** [slept longer than I planned or wanted to].

C Thanks and replies

These are some common ways of **thanking** people, with typical replies.

A: **Thanks** (**very much**).
B: **Not at all**. (also **That's OK**.)

A: I've brought your books.
B: Oh, **cheers**. (*infml*)
A: **No problem**. (*infml*)

A: I'll post those letters for you.
B: Oh, thank you. **That's very kind of you**. (This is polite and slightly more formal.)

Exercises

65.1 Find three more pairs of phrases that have a similar meaning.

~~thanks very much~~	I'm terribly sorry	don't worry	never mind
I was held up	~~cheers~~	I beg your pardon	there was a delay

thanks very much / cheers .....

.....

.....

.....

65.2 Complete the dialogues with one word. Contractions (e.g. *I'm)* count as one word.

1 A: I'm *terribly* ..... sorry.
B: That's OK.

2 A: Thanks very much.
B: ..... at all.

3 A: Sorry to ..... you waiting. I won't be ..... .
B: That's all ..... .

4 A: I'm sorry ..... late. The 7:30 train was ..... , so I had to wait for the next one.
B: That's OK. No ..... .

5 A: I gave your parents a lift to the station.
B: Oh, thanks. That's very ..... of you.

6 A: I must ..... for missing the meeting yesterday afternoon.
B: ..... mind. I'll ask Claire to tell you what happened.

7 A: I ..... your pardon. I thought the room was empty.
B: That's OK.

65.3 What could you say in these situations? If it is an apology, give an explanation.

1 You walk into someone by accident and he/she almost falls over.
I'm terribly sorry. OR I beg your pardon. I didn't see you.

2 You arrange to meet some friends in town at 9 am but you are twenty minutes late.
.....

3 Your car has broken down. You're pushing it to the side of the road and a man offers to help.
.....

4 You need to speak to your boss but she's working. What do you say when you enter her office?
.....

5 You have to leave a meeting to take an important phone call. What do you say to the others?
.....

6 You are on the phone but a customer is waiting to talk to you. What can you say to them?
.....

7 You are late for an appointment because you had to wait half an hour in traffic.
.....

8 Your company promised to send some information to a customer last week. You still haven't sent the information and you must now write to explain. Write the first sentence of your letter.
.....

65.4 Over to you

Answer the questions. If possible, compare your answers with someone else.

1 Are you ever late for class or work? If so, do you have to apologise to anyone? Do you normally give a reason why you are late? If so, what reasons are most common?

2 What other things have you apologised for recently? What did you say? Did you give an excuse?

66 Requests, permission and suggestions

A Requests and replies


A: **Could you** pass the salt?


B: **Sure**. / **No problem**.


A: **Could you possibly** help me?


B: Yes, **of course**.


A: Naomi, **I wonder if you could** help me?


B: Sure.


A: **I was wondering if you could** lend me some money until tomorrow.


B: No, **I'm afraid I can't**. [I'm sorry but I can't.]

Language help

As the requests become bigger it is normal to use longer phrases which sound more **polite**.

B Asking permission and replies


A: **Could I possibly** have a look at your magazine?


B: Yes, **help yourself**.


A: **May / Could I** open the window?


B: Sure, **go ahead**.


A: **Do you mind if I** watch TV?


B: No, go ahead.

Language help

When we answer **go ahead** or **help yourself**, we are giving someone permission to do the thing they have asked.

C Suggestions and replies



We could try that new restaurant.

How about going to a club?

What **shall we** do tonight?

I don't mind. You choose.

Let's go to the café in the square.

Why don't we go and see a film?

Do you fancy listening to some music? [do you want to; *infml*]

We can reply with different answers, from positive to negative.

Yeah, (**that's a**) **great idea**.
That **sounds good**.

Yes, **if you like**.
Yeah, **I don't mind**.

No, **I don't fancy that**.
Mm, **I'd rather** do something else. [I would prefer to do something else.]

Exercises

66.1 Correct six more mistakes in the dialogue.

A: ~~Do~~ you like to go out this evening? *Would*
B: I'm afraid but I haven't got any money.
A: That's OK. I'll pay. How about go to see a film?
B: No, I think I'd rather to stay in. I have to do some homework.
A: Why you don't do your homework this afternoon?
B: I'm busy this afternoon.
A: Well, we could to go tomorrow.
B: Yeah, it's a great idea.

66.2 Match 1–6 with a–f.

1 Could you close the door?	*c*	a a suggestion
2 May I close the window?		b a negative reply
3 We could go to the cinema.		c a request
4 Yeah, great idea.		d asking for permission
5 I wonder if you could close the door?		e a positive reply
6 I don't fancy that.		f a polite request

66.3 Complete the dialogues with one word. Contractions (e.g. *don't)* count as one word.

1 A: What *would* ..... you like to do this weekend?
B: I don't ..... . You decide.

2 A: Could you ..... open that window? It's very hot in here.
B: Yes, of ..... .

3 A: I was ..... if you could give me a lift to Luke's this evening.
B: Sure, no ..... .

4 A: What do you ..... doing this evening?
B: I don't ..... . Any ideas?
A: Why ..... we go to the cinema? We haven't been for ages.
B: Yeah, that's a great ..... .

5 A: Do you ..... if I use your phone?
B: No, go ..... .

6 A: OK. Where ..... we go on Saturday?
B: How ..... going to the beach if the weather's nice?
A: Yeah. Or we ..... try that new sports centre just outside town.
B: Mmm. I think I'd ..... go to the beach.
A: Yes, OK, if you ..... .

66.4 Reply to the questions. Try to give a different answer each time.

1 Could I borrow your pen for a minute? *Yes, sure.* .....
2 Could you possibly post a letter for me? .....
3 I was wondering if you've got a suitcase you could lend me? .....
4 Do you mind if I take this chair? .....
5 I've got some tickets for a concert. Do you fancy going? .....
6 How about going to a football match at the weekend? .....
7 Why don't we meet this afternoon and practise our English? .....

67 Opinions, agreeing and disagreeing

A Asking someone for their opinion

What do you think of his new book / Tom's girlfriend? (asking about a specific thing or person)
What do you think about global warming / cosmetic surgery? (asking about a general topic)
How do you feel about working with the others?

B Introducing your own opinion

Personally, I think Helena was probably right**.**
Personally, I feel that we should increase the price**.**
In my opinion [I think**],** we need to change the direction of the company**.**
My view/feeling is [my opinion is] that we need to wait a bit longer**.**

Common mistakes

Personally, I **don't think it's** a good idea. (NOT I ~~think it's not~~ a good idea.)
In my **opinion**, motorbikes are dangerous. (NOT ~~On~~ my opinion OR In my ~~meaning~~)
In most situations, it is probably easier and more natural to use **personally**.

C Giving the opinion of others

The newspaper **says** that his death was not an accident. (NOT ~~It's written~~ in the newspaper)
According to the paper [the paper says], the government didn't know about it**.**

D Agreeing and disagreeing (with someone)

I **totally agree (with you)** [agree completely, 100%].
I **partly agree (with you)** [agree but not completely].
I **agree (with you) to a certain extent** [partly agree].

Common mistakes

I agree with you. (NOT ~~I'm agree~~ with you.)
Do you agree? (NOT ~~Are you~~ agree?)

In British English, it is common to agree with someone before giving a different opinion.
That's true, but I think …
I see what you mean, [I understand what you are saying] but …
I agree to some extent, but …
I think that's a good **point** [idea or opinion], **but** …
I **take your point** [I understand and partly agree with your opinion], **but** ...

E Giving a strong opinion

I **feel very strongly about** military service.
I think everyone should do it.



I think you're **absolutely right**/ **wrong** [100% correct/wrong]**.**



I don't agree **at all** [I completely disagree].



I **disagree completely** [100% don't agree].



Exercises

67.1 **Complete the questions in different ways to ask people their opinion.**

1 What do you think *about* ..... sending people to Mars?
2 ..... these shoes? Do you like them?
3 ..... having more responsibility?

67.2 **Complete the dialogues.**

1 A: Did you think he was right in what he said?
B: Not completely, but I *partly* ..... agreed with him.

2 A: What did you think ..... the film?
B: Well, ... I didn't like it.

3 A: Do you agree with her?
B: Yes, to a certain ..... .

4 A: She feels very ..... about protecting the environment.
B: Yes, I know, and I think she's absolutely ..... .

5 A: ....., I think all politicians tell lies.
B: Sorry, but I ..... completely.

6 A: We can't send everyone to university.
B: Yes, that's ....., but we should give everyone a chance to go.

7 A: My ..... is that we should make all chocolate and sweets more expensive, and then people couldn't afford to eat so many things that are bad for them.
B: That's a good ....., but it seems unfair on people who don't eat too many sweet things.

8 A: I see what you ..... about spending more money, but can we afford it?
B: Well, in my ..... we have no choice.

67.3 **Rewrite the sentences using the words in capitals. Keep a similar meaning.**

1 I think you're right. AGREE *I agree with you.*
2 I think the club needs new players. OPINION .....
3 I completely disagree with you. AT ALL .....
4 The newspaper says the fire was started on purpose. ACCORDING .....
.....
5 I partly agree with her. EXTENT .....
6 I see what you mean, but I'm not sure I agree. POINT .....
.....

67.4 **Over to you**

Respond to the statements with your own opinion. If possible, compare your answers with someone else.

1 I think most women are happy to stay at home and be a mother and housewife.
.....

2 Personally I don't think the government should give so much money to people who don't work.
.....

3 My feeling is that we should give more money to poor countries in other parts of the world.
.....

4 I think we should make it more expensive to drive a car in order to reduce the number of cars.
.....

68 Likes, dislikes, attitudes and preferences

A Likes and dislikes

	agree	disagree
I **love** rock music. I'**m really into** dance music. [like it very much; *infml*] I like a lot of pop music. 	**So do I. / Me too.** **So am I**. / Me too. So do I. / Me too.	**Really?** I don't. Really? I'm not. Do you? I hate it.
I **quite** like salsa and samba. I **don't mind** jazz. [it's OK]	So do I. / Me too. Yeah, it's OK.	Oh, I'm not very keen. Oh, I can't stand it.
I'm **not very keen on** folk music. I **can't stand** classical music. [dislike it very much; *infml*] I **hate** opera. 	**Neither am I.** / **Me neither.** **Neither can I**. / Me neither. So do I. / Me too.	 Really? I love it. Really? I quite like it.

Language help

Many of these verbs can be followed by a noun or an *-ing* form, e.g. *I love driving, I like singing, I don't mind work, I dislike driving, I can't stand getting up early, I hate cold weather.*

B Attitudes and interests

My **attitude to** a lot of things has changed over the years. [how you think or feel about something]
I **used to** like chips. [I liked chips in the past but not now.]
I used to play computer games, but now they **don't interest** me. [I don't find them interesting.]
I'm very **interested in** modern architecture, but I used to think it was awful.
I used to go swimming a lot, but now I don't go **at all** [*at all* makes a negative stronger].
Mark and I used to have the same **interests** [things we enjoy doing], but now it seems we **have nothing in common** [have no interests that are similar; *opp* **have a lot in common**].

Common mistakes

I'm **interested in** see**ing** that. (NOT I'm ~~interest~~ in seeing that; OR I'm interested ~~to see~~ that.)

It takes time to **get used to** [become familiar with] liv**ing** in a different country.
I didn't like my new glasses at first, but now I've **got used to** them.
I found the winters very cold at first, but you **get used to** it.

C Which do you, or would you, prefer?



A: Which do you **prefer** in general, tea or coffee? [like more]



B: Well, I **prefer** coffee **to** tea in the morning, but in the afternoon I usually drink tea.



A: Tonight, we can go to the cinema or the theatre. Which **would you prefer**?



B: I think **I'd prefer to** go to the cinema. (*syn* **I'd rather**)

Exercises

68.1 Correct the mistakes in B's replies.

1 A: I can drive.
B: So ~~do~~ I. *can*

2 A: I love modern art.
B: Yes, so I do. .....

3 A: Do you like chocolate?
B: Yes, I like very much. .....

4 A: Do you like it in England?
B: Yes, I'm getting used to live here. .....

5 A: I don't like shopping.
B: Me too. .....

6 A: Do you like football?
B: Yes, but I prefer rugby than football.
.....

7 A: Do you like this?
B: No, I'm not interest in music.
.....

68.2 Complete each sentence with one word.

1 My sister loves Robbie Williams, but I can't *stand* him.
2 The two boys have nothing in ..... ; they're completely different.
3 The others enjoyed the film, but I didn't like it at ..... .
4 I love the cinema, but this particular film doesn't ..... me.
5 Carole is really ..... modern art at the moment. Personally, I hate it.
6 I ..... to love cheese, but I never eat it now.
7 A: Would you like to go out? B: I'd ..... stay here, actually. Is that OK with you?
8 I didn't like raw fish at first, but I'm ..... used to it now.

68.3 Agree with the statements using so or *neither* and the correct verb. Then agree using *Me too* or *Me neither.*

1 I love this ice cream.	*So do I.*	*Me too.*
2 I like strawberries.	.....	.....
3 I don't like cold tea.	.....	.....
4 I can't work with music on.	.....	.....
5 I'm single.	.....	.....
6 I'm not married.	.....	.....
7 I've got a cat.	.....	.....

68.4 Rewrite the sentences using the word in capitals. Keep a similar meaning.

1 He likes salsa. INTO *He's into salsa.*
2 I hate these new shoes. STAND .....
3 She'd prefer to go home. RATHER .....
4 I don't like James Bond films very much. KEEN .....
5 I think the new building is alright. MIND .....
6 I went riding a lot in the past, but not now. USED .....
7 We have a lot of the same interests. COMMON .....
8 I'm becoming familiar with this new computer. USED .....
9 I don't feel the same way about work now. ATTITUDE .....

68.5 Over to you

Complete the sentences. If possible, compare your answers with someone else.

I really like ..... .
I don't mind ..... .
I can't stand ..... .
I prefer ..... to ..... .
..... doesn't interest me.
I used to ..... .

69 Greetings, farewells and special expressions

A Greetings*

When we are **introduced to** a **stranger** [told the name of someone we have never met] in a formal **situation**, we usually **shake hands** and *say hello*, or perhaps **hello, nice to meet you**. In an informal situation, we usually just say *hello* or *hi*.

When we **greet** friends, there are no real rules in Britain. Men may kiss **female** friends [girls/women] on one **cheek** [side of the face], on both cheeks, or not at all. Women may kiss **male** friends and female friends **once**, **twice**, or not at all. We usually say things like this:

A: Hello. How are you? B: Fine, thanks. **How about** you?
A: Hi. **How's it going?** / **How are things?** (*infml*) B: **Not** (**so**) **bad**, thanks. And you?

* saying hello

B Farewells*

To someone we have just met for the first time we can say **Goodbye. Nice to meet you**.

With friends we can say **bye, cheers** (*infml*), **take care** (*infml*), or **see you** (soon/later/tomorrow, etc.).

When we say goodbye to a school or work friend on Friday afternoon we usually say:
A: Have a nice weekend.
B: Yeah, **same to you**. (NOT same ~~for~~ you)

* saying goodbye

C Expressions for special situations



Language help

We use **Thank goodness** when we are happy that something bad did not happen. A synonym is **Thank God** (*infml*), but there are some people who may not like the use of this expression. We can use *Goodness* on its own to express surprise, e.g. *Goodness, is it ten o'clock already?*

Exercises

69.1 Find five more phrases.

~~good~~	take	excuse	bless	~~luck~~	you
thank	me	goodness	not	care	bad

good luck ....

....

69.2 Complete the dialogues.

1 A: How are you?
B: Fine. How *about* ..... you?

2 A: How's it ..... ?
B: Not ..... . And you?

3 A: Have a nice weekend.
B: Yeah, ... you.

4 A: Nobody was hurt in the accident.
B: Oh, ... for that.

5 A: I'll see you tomorrow.
B: Yeah, ... care.

6 A: I've just passed my exam.
B: ..... !

7 A: I'm fine, thanks.
B: Good. And ..... Sarah?

69.3 What could you say in these situations?

1 A friend says, 'Have a good weekend'. What do you reply? *Yeah, same to you.*
2 You met a new business client for the first time fifteen minutes ago, and now you are leaving. What do you say? .....
3 You are on a crowded bus. It is your stop and you want to get off. What do you say to other passengers as you move past them? .....
4 A friend tells you they have just won some money. What do you say? .....
5 A friend is going for a job interview this afternoon. What do you say? .....
6 You are having a drink with friends. What do you say when you hold up your glasses to drink? .....
7 Someone sneezes next to you. What do you say? .....

69.4 Complete the sentences.

1 When you meet someone for the first time in a formal *situation* , what do you say?
2 When you are ..... to someone in a formal situation, do you normally ..... hands?
3 What do you do and say when you ..... friends?
4 Do you usually kiss friends? If so, is it on one ..... or both ..... ?
5 When you say goodbye to friends, do you use informal expressions like *Cheers,* or *Take* ..... ? If so, what are they?

69.5 Over to you

Answer the questions in Exercise 69.4 about your country. If possible, ask someone from a different country the same questions.

70 Prefixes: changing meaning

A With adjectives

Prefixes, e.g. **un-**, **dis-**, **im-**, can be added to some adjectives to give the opposite meaning.

happy	**un**happy
possible	**im**possible
regular	**ir**regular

honest [tells the truth]	**dishonest**
correct [right✓]	**incorrect**
legal [allowed by law]	**illegal**

Dan used all the milk but said he didn't; he's very **dishonest**.
I got eight answers right, but two were **incorrect**.
It's **illegal** in the UK to ride a motorbike without a helmet.

B *un-*

Of the prefixes above, **un-** is the most common, and appears in a number of adjectives.

This chair is incredibly **uncomfortable**.
It was **unnecessary** for them to wait for us.
Xerxes – that's a very **unusual** name. [different, not common or ordinary]
I won the game; it was completely **unexpected**. [I didn't think I was going to win]
Marsha's hat is **unbelievable**. [surprising because it is either very good or very bad]
We tried to open the door, but we **were unable to** get in. [could not]
I need to do more exercise; I'm very **unfit**. [not healthy and not in good condition]
Declan played well, and I thought he was **unlucky** to lose.
They're **unlikely** to get here before midday. [They probably won't get here before midday.]
The test was **unfair** because some of the students had more time to do it than others. [If something is *unfair,* it does not treat people equally.]

Language help

Adding a negative prefix does not usually change the pronunciation; the stress stays the same.
She was un'lucky. It's unbe'lievable. (NOT She was '~~unlucky~~. It was '~~unbelievable~~.)

C With verbs

With some verbs, these prefixes can have particular meanings.

dis- [the opposite of something]	I **disagree** with the others. [don't agree / have the same opinion] The plane **appeared** in the sky, then it **disappeared** behind a cloud.
un- [the opposite of an action]	I couldn't **unlock** the door this morning. [open the door using a key; *opp* **lock**] We had to **get undressed** in the cold. [take off our clothes; *opp* **get dressed**] I **unpacked** the bags. [took everything out of the bags; *opp* **pack**]
over- [too much]	The bank **overcharged** me. [asked me to pay too much money]
mis- [do something incorrectly]	I **misunderstood** what he said; I'm afraid my English isn't very good. I **misheard** her. I thought she said *Rita*, not *Brita*.
re- [again**]**	The teacher has asked me to **rewrite** my essay.

Exercises

70.1 Write the opposite.

1 un happy
2 .....able
3 .....correct
4 .....usual
5 .....possible
6 .....comfortable
7 .....agree
8 .....necessary
9 .....regular
10 .....honest
11 .....fair
12 .....lucky

70.2 Which sentence on the right logically follows each sentence on the left?

1 She arrived home.	b	a She unpacked her suitcase.
2 Her essay was terrible.		b She unlocked the front door.
3 She decided to go to bed.		c She has disappeared.
4 He called her name.		d She had overcharged me.
5 She's not here now.		e She had to rewrite it.
6 He thought he was right.		f She misheard it.
7 She got to the hotel.		g She disagreed.
8 After I paid, I looked at the price.		h She got undressed.

70.3 Complete the dialogues so that B agrees with A using different words. You only need one word for each gap.

1 A: Adera is a strange name.
B: Yes, very unusual.
2 A: It's against the law, isn't it?
B: Oh yes, it's .....
3 A: You mean he took off all his clothes!
B: Yes, he got completely .....
4 A: He probably won't get back in time for the meeting.
B: I agree. It's very .....
5 A: A lot of the answers were wrong.
B: Yes, I'm afraid they were nearly all .....
6 A: He doesn't look in very good condition; he's a bit overweight.
B: I know. He looks terribly .....
7 A: Nobody thought this would happen.
B: Yes, it was completely .....
8 A: They never tell the truth.
B: I know. They're both .....
9 A: His business always seems to lose money, and it's not his fault.
B: I know. He's very .....
10 A: Ann always gives more attention to Sarah than she does to Lucas.
B: Yes, it's very ..... on poor Lucas.

70.4 These words all appear in other units of the book. Do you know how to form the opposites?

pleasant	unpleasant	fashionable	.....
kind	.....	reliable	.....
patient (adj)	.....	friendly	.....
suitable	.....	tidy	.....
like (v)	.....	ability	.....
do up	.....	sociable	.....